



Walmart workers rat out faulty AI

Walmart employees told WIRED the AI used to detect theft in the stores doesn't work as intended. <https://digit.in/jun20-80>



Apple sign in security flaw

Researcher Bhavuk Jain found a security flaw in the 'sign in with Apple' service on third-party apps. <https://digit.in/jun20-81>

Smartphone cameras have overtaken most bigger camera types as the preferred tools of photography, and you would not be wrong to make that assumption. Smartphones now have insane image processing techniques built-in like semantic segmentation, multi-frame blending and of course, high dynamic range algorithms. A point and shoot camera or even the most professional of DSLRs cannot match these features, but they do come with some costs on the smartphone. All this image processing can take a hit on the detail, but more importantly, takes all control in terms of the look of the image away from you. This is where Pro mode comes in. Pro

mode is implemented differently on different phones, depending on a variety of factors like the camera stack and of course, the processor on the phone along with the corresponding ISP.

First let us dig a little deeper and examine why you would want to use the Pro mode in the first place. There are two strong reasons to consider shooting in Pro mode. Firstly, it gives you access to RAW capture, which delivers the highest detail retention, and the maximum editability in an image. Try changing anything in a JPG file and you will quickly notice tearing in colours, but in a RAW file you have a lot more room before this happens. The second reason to use Pro mode is to take control over the camera's expo-

sure settings. Maybe you are shooting in low light but instead of using a slow shutter speed, the camera keeps increasing the ISO, resulting in an image with heavy noise. Switch over to Pro mode and you can control the settings to your liking. With the added advantage of RAW capture and Pro mode combined, you could effectively create a photograph that is far more elegant than the product of the auto mode.

Not all smartphones offer a Pro mode, and even those that do, may not offer all the features that Pro mode should have. Ideally, Pro mode should incorporate the ability to change the shutter speed, precisely set the focus point using a distance slider, manually set the white balance and of course,

GOING PRO

Taking your smartphone photography to the next level with Pro Mode

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